

Fight, Flight, Freeze, Fawn — Which One Is You?

Understanding Your Nervous System's Survival Genius

"Be still and know that I am God." — Psalm 46:10

KEY CONCEPTS

1 The four responses

Fight: you push back, argue, defend. Flight: you escape — physically or mentally. Freeze: you go blank, numb, can't move or speak. Fawn: you appease, agree, make yourself small to neutralise the threat. None of these are character flaws. All of them are survival intelligence.

2 Why fawn is the most common in narcissistic relationships

When the threat is someone you love — and when fighting or leaving feels too dangerous — the nervous system learns to fawn. To manage, to smooth, to become whatever the other person needs. Many survivors don't even know they were fawning. They called it love.

3 The nervous system is not the enemy

God designed your body to protect you. These responses worked. The problem is they get stuck — they keep running after the threat is gone. Healing is not about fighting your nervous system. It's about teaching it that you are safe now.

THIS WEEK'S PRACTICE

Identify your primary response: When someone was angry with you in your relationship, what did your body do first? Tighten and argue back? Run away mentally? Go blank? Become very helpful very quickly? Write it down without judgment.

YOUR REFLECTION

'My nervous system protected me. I am grateful for its wisdom. I am now learning to help it feel safe.'

YOUR NOTES & JOURNAL SPACE

WANT TO GO DEEPER?

The full community curriculum includes a complete nervous system education with somatic practices to gently discharge stored survival energy. Inside Reclaim Your Self at \$27/month, we do this together week by week.

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